CSE0001 – Digital Literacy

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INTRODUCTION

This project focuses on developing essential digital skills required for academic and professional success in today's technology-driven world. As a Digital Ambassador, the objective was to explore various online tools, platforms, and best practices related to digital literacy, communication, and cybersecurity. The project includes creating visual content, building professional profiles, practicing coding skills, using collaborative tools, and understanding safe online behavior. Each task was designed to provide practical exposure to real-world digital scenarios, helping in both technical and non-technical skill development. Through activities such as designing an infographic, creating a quiz, writing professional emails, and analyzing cybercrime, the project emphasizes responsible and effective use of digital resources. Overall, it aims to prepare students to confidently navigate the digital environment while maintaining professionalism and security.

1. CREATE A DIGITAL LITERACY AWARENESS INFOGRAPHIC

I created a digital literacy infographic that highlights important topics such as what digital literacy is, useful digital tools for students, safe internet practices, and email etiquette. The infographic is designed to present key information in a clear, structured, and visually appealing way so that students can easily understand essential digital skills. I used Canva to design this infographic because it is a free and user-friendly tool that provides a variety of templates, icons, and design elements. While working on this task, I found it interesting to organize information in a visual format rather than plain text, as it required more creativity and planning. One challenge I faced was balancing the content and design, since adding too much information made the infographic look cluttered. This task helped me improve my ability to present information concisely while maintaining an attractive and readable layout.

2. BUILD YOUR STUDENT DIGITAL PORTFOLIO

I created and updated my profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle as part of this task. GitHub is mainly used for storing and managing code, collaborating on projects, and showcasing technical work through repositories and a profile README. LinkedIn is a professional networking platform where I added my education details, which helps in building a professional identity and connecting with peers, mentors, and potential employers. Kaggle is a platform for data science and machine learning where users can practice with datasets, participate in competitions, and improve analytical skills. Over the next four years, I plan to actively use GitHub to upload my academic and personal projects, improving my coding and version control skills. I will use LinkedIn to build my professional network, share achievements, and explore internship and job opportunities. On Kaggle, I aim to enhance my knowledge in data science by working on real-world datasets and participating in competitions. These platforms will help me grow both technically and professionally, preparing me for future career opportunities.

3. EXPLORE CODING & COLLABORATION PLATFORMS

I used HackerRank and Google Workspace tools to complete this task. On HackerRank, I created an account and solved a beginner-level problem, which helped me practice basic programming concepts and understand problem-solving approaches. This platform is useful for improving coding skills through structured challenges and real-time feedback. For the collaboration part, I used Google Forms to create a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz consisting of five questions, including multiple-choice and short-answer types. I also linked the form responses to Google Sheets to analyze the collected data efficiently.
Through this activity, I learned how to design simple quizzes and use cloud-based tools for collecting and organizing information. One of the key benefits of these tools is that they allow easy sharing and collaboration among students. In the future, I plan to continue using HackerRank to strengthen my programming skills and prepare for technical interviews. I will also use Google Forms and Sheets for academic surveys, group projects, and data analysis tasks. These platforms will help me improve both my technical and collaborative abilities, which are essential for academic and professional growth.

4. DRAFT A PROFESSIONAL EMAIL & ETIQUETTE GUIDE

Poor digital communication can often lead to misunderstandings and negative consequences. For example, a student once sent an email to a professor using informal language and without a proper subject line, which caused the email to be ignored. As a result, the student missed an important deadline and faced academic penalties. This situation could have been avoided by following proper email etiquette, such as using a clear subject line, maintaining a respectful tone, and structuring the message properly. Professional communication ensures that the message is taken seriously and understood clearly. It is important to review messages before sending them and ensure they are polite and well-organized. Practicing good digital communication skills helps build a positive impression and prevents unnecessary issues in academic and professional environments.

5. CYBERCRIME AWARENESS CASE STUDY & PREVENTION GUIDE

While researching cybercrime, I was most surprised by how easily people can fall victim to scams like UPI fraud, even when the process seems simple. I learned that many fraud cases do not involve advanced hacking but instead rely on social engineering, where attackers manipulate victims into making mistakes themselves. For example, many users are tricked into entering their UPI PIN while “receiving” money, which actually authorizes a payment. This showed me that lack of awareness is one of the biggest reasons behind such crimes. I also found it interesting how quickly money can be transferred and how difficult it can be to recover once the transaction is completed. As a result of this research, one habit I will personally change is being more cautious while handling digital payments. I will always verify payment requests, avoid scanning unknown QR codes, and never share sensitive information like OTPs or PINs. Additionally, I will stay informed about common scams and educate others around me to prevent such incidents.

CONCLUSION

This project provided a comprehensive understanding of digital literacy and its importance in academic and professional life. It helped in developing practical skills such as using online tools, creating professional profiles, practicing coding, and communicating effectively through emails. The tasks also increased awareness about cybersecurity and responsible digital behavior. By completing this project, I improved both my technical and communication skills. Overall, it was a valuable learning experience that will help me use digital platforms more efficiently and prepare for future academic and career opportunities.